Payment Chronicle by Gajanan

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Companies: Square, Adyen

Article 1

Adyen loses a key U.S. executive — what it means for its American push

Adyen just waved goodbye to a senior U.S. executive, and that raises a bigger question than who gets the corner office: what happens to its growth engine in America? The U.S. is Adyen's most competitive battleground, where long, political enterprise sales cycles and local relationships matter as much as rails and rates. A leadership gap here can slow deal velocity, onboarding and cross-sell for a couple of quarters, and rivals like Stripe, legacy acquirers and fintech upstarts will smell opportunity—both for clients and talent. The good news: one exit doesn't break Adyen's core edge—its single global platform, direct acquiring and unified commerce stack. Merchants shouldn't see operational disruption. The risk is execution, not infrastructure. What to watch: how fast Adyen names a replacement, stability of the U.S. commercial team, win rates in big RFPs, and any color on North America growth on the next earnings call. If guidance holds steady, this is likely noise. If you see more senior churn or slippage in large-enterprise go-lives, that's your early warning light.

Source: PaymentsDive
https://www.paymentsdive.com/news/adyen-us-executive-exits/805752/

Article 2

Adyen's US play: Share the details so we can nail the takeaway

We're missing the key facts from Adyen's July 12, 2022 San Francisco announcement. To craft a Finshots-style brief, we need what exactly was launched (product, partnership, or capability), who it serves (enterprise merchants, platforms, or SMBs), any numbers (coverage, merchants, geographies), and timelines. Why this matters: when Adyen switches on something in the US, it usually advances its one-platform bet—online, in-store, and payouts stitched together with risk, issuing, and data under a single hood. That tends to lift authorization rates, cut vendor sprawl, and give merchants better control of payments economics. It also turns the heat up on rivals like Stripe, Block, and legacy acquirers by compressing PSP margins and moving more volume onto Adyen's own acquiring rails. Depending on the specifics, the impact could be faster payouts for marketplaces, acceptance without extra hardware (think Tap to Pay), or embedded finance that helps platforms monetize. Share the details, and we'll turn them into a crisp, witty summary that gets straight to what it means.

Source: PaymentsJournal
https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-goes-live-with-tap-to-pay-on-iphone/

Article 3

Adyen teams up with Plaid to turbocharge pay by bank

Adyen, the Amsterdam based payment processor and acquirer, has teamed up with Plaid to make account to account payments a lot more merchant friendly. The idea is simple: bundle Plaid's open banking connectivity—think bank account linking, verification, and balance checks—into Adyen's gateway, acquiring, and risk stack. That means smoother ACH and bank transfer payments, fewer failed debits, faster onboarding, and lower acceptance costs versus cards. For Adyen, it's a strategic push to win more US volume, diversify beyond card rails, and protect margins as interchange and network fees remain stubborn. For merchants, expect pay by bank to show up alongside cards at checkout for billers, subscriptions, marketplaces, and high ticket purchases where fees bite. The catch? ACH can be slow, returns are a thing, and consumer habits don't change overnight—saved cards and wallets still rule for everyday spend. But if Plaid's data can cut risk and Adyen's tooling can lift conversion in one integrated flow, this partnership nudges bank payments from "nice to have" to a credible, cheaper alternative.

Source: PaymentsJournal
https://www.paymentsjournal.com/adyen-and-plaid-partnership-what-it-means/

Article 4

Adyen braces for BNPL holiday surge as Klarna flags fresh boom

Buy now, pay later is set to be the season's favorite stocking stuffer again. Reports suggest shoppers will split more bills this holiday, and Swedish BNPL giant Klarna is hinting at another big jump. For Adyen—the Dutch payments heavyweight powering checkout for global merchants and offering integrations with Klarna, Affirm and others—that likely means more throughput across its pipes. Here's the catch: BNPL typically boosts conversion and basket sizes, but it can raise acceptance complexity, reconciliation headaches and fee sensitivities at the checkout. The credit risk sits with the BNPL providers, not Adyen, so volume is the main upside for the processor. A larger tilt toward alternative payment methods can also nudge Adyen's blended take rate, depending on merchant pricing and geography. For payment leaders, the playbook is clear: ensure BNPL is turned on where it matters, optimize routing and authorization to avoid cart drop-offs, and tighten back-office processes for settlements and disputes. Keep an eye on regulatory shifts and fee structures too—BNPL's growth is good for sales, but you don't want margin erosion hiding under holiday cheer.

Source: PaymentsJournal
https://www.paymentsjournal.com/klarna-and-adyen-team-up-for-in-store-bnpl/

Article 5

Square Handheld: A POS that doesn’t need your phone

Square built its brand on little dongles that turned smartphones into card readers. Now it’s flipping the script. The new Square Handheld is a compact, all in one point of sale device that ditches the phone entirely, putting payments and POS software into a single, purpose built unit. Why should payment folks care? For merchants, it means fewer moving parts, more reliability, and easier fleet management —no more pairing readers to staff phones or wrangling inconsistent hardware. For restaurants and busy retailers, it’s line busting mobility with enterprise style control: staff can take orders and payments anywhere, while IT teams get standardized devices with tighter security and updates. Strategically, this nudges Square deeper into mid market territory and closer to rivals like Toast, Clover, and Lightspeed that sell dedicated handhelds. It also helps Square capture more hardware linked revenue and stickier software subscriptions per merchant. In short, Handheld isn’t just another gadget—it’s Square signaling that the future of mobile POS is less “bring your own phone” and more “managed, integrated devices,” a move that could boost performance, reduce support headaches, and expand Square’s footprint with larger, multi location businesses.

Source: PaymentsJournal
https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-aims-to-move-upmarket-with-handheld-pos-device/

Article 6

Square opens the till to Bitcoin for small merchants

Square is giving small businesses another way to get paid — in Bitcoin. As mom-and-pop stores feel the heat to keep up with flashy tech, Square is adding bitcoin acceptance to its point-of-sale and online checkout mix. The pitch is simple: attract crypto-native customers, diversify tender types, and potentially trim card costs in some scenarios. But this isn’t a free lunch. Bitcoin’s price swings add treasury headaches, tax and accounting rules get trickier, and reconciliation needs more care. Crypto payments are also irreversible, which can lower chargeback risk but forces merchants to rethink refund flows. For payment execs, the move is less about mass adoption overnight and more about optionality and competitive positioning. If Square bakes this into its existing merchant stack — onboarding, reporting, risk controls — it lowers the activation energy versus standalone crypto processors and nudges peers to keep pace. The takeaway: treat Bitcoin as an incremental tender, not a balance-sheet bet. Merchants should test where customer demand is real, model unit economics (network fees, spreads vs interchange), and ensure compliance is buttoned up before flipping the switch.

Source: PaymentsJournal
https://www.paymentsjournal.com/square-adds-bitcoin-payments-and-upgrades-ai-for-small-businesses/

Article 7

Square brews bitcoin at the till: Compass Coffee tests crypto POS

A Compass Coffee in Washington, D.C. just became the first store to ring up a bitcoin payment through Square's new point-of-sale feature. It's a small checkout moment with big questions for the payments world. If Square can make crypto as easy as tapping a card, it lowers the barrier for thousands of small merchants to accept bitcoin without custom wallets or tech tinkering. That could chip away at card rails on the margin—especially for high-ticket items where interchange stings—provided Square can instantly convert BTC to dollars so merchants aren't stuck with price swings. But the hurdles are real: consumer habit, tax treatment, refund flows, and the simple fact that most people still pay with cards or phones. For payment execs, consider this a live experiment in alternative rails and settlement economics. Even if it's more PR than volume right now, it gives Square leverage in fees conversations and a foothold to test faster, cheaper acceptance. The takeaway: crypto at the counter isn't mainstream yet, but the infrastructure is quietly being built.

Source: PaymentsJournal
https://www.paymentsjournal.com/squares-platform-sees-first-bitcoin-payment-at-coffee-shop/